

Description of the sites

Site no. 4

el-Habayel (A)

Isr. Grid Ref. 1834/2001

The flint and stone assemblages:

Chalcolithic Period (main part of assemblage) – highly reasonable identification. Wadi Rabah phase (few artifacts) – possible identification.

Waste and flint artifacts without retouch:

Discoid core with yellow patina 1; Discoid core 1; Primary flake 6; Flake 5; Blade 1.

Total – 16

Flint Tools and retouched artifacts:

Axe 5; Adze 3; Chisel 3; Chisel with lateral polish 1; Broken bifacial tool 3; Pick 1; De'jete scraper on small flake 5; Rounded scraper 1; Fan scraper 1; Side scraper 2; Burin 1; Notch 6; Massive borer 1; Awl 1; Retouched flake 6; Thick backed blade (similar to type D sickle, Gopher 1989a, 95) 2; Blade (similar to type C sickle, Gopher 1989a, 95) 1; Retouched blade 5; Truncation 4; Backed knife 1. Total – 53.

Total of flint artifacts – 69.

The stone artifacts:

Coarse adze or hoe of limestone 4; Fragment of flat and rimmed basalt base 1; Fragment of conical basalt rim 1; Fragment of conical basalt bowl 1; Fragment of base of a ba-

salt incense burner 1; Fragment of a basalt pebble with a bi-conical hole 1.

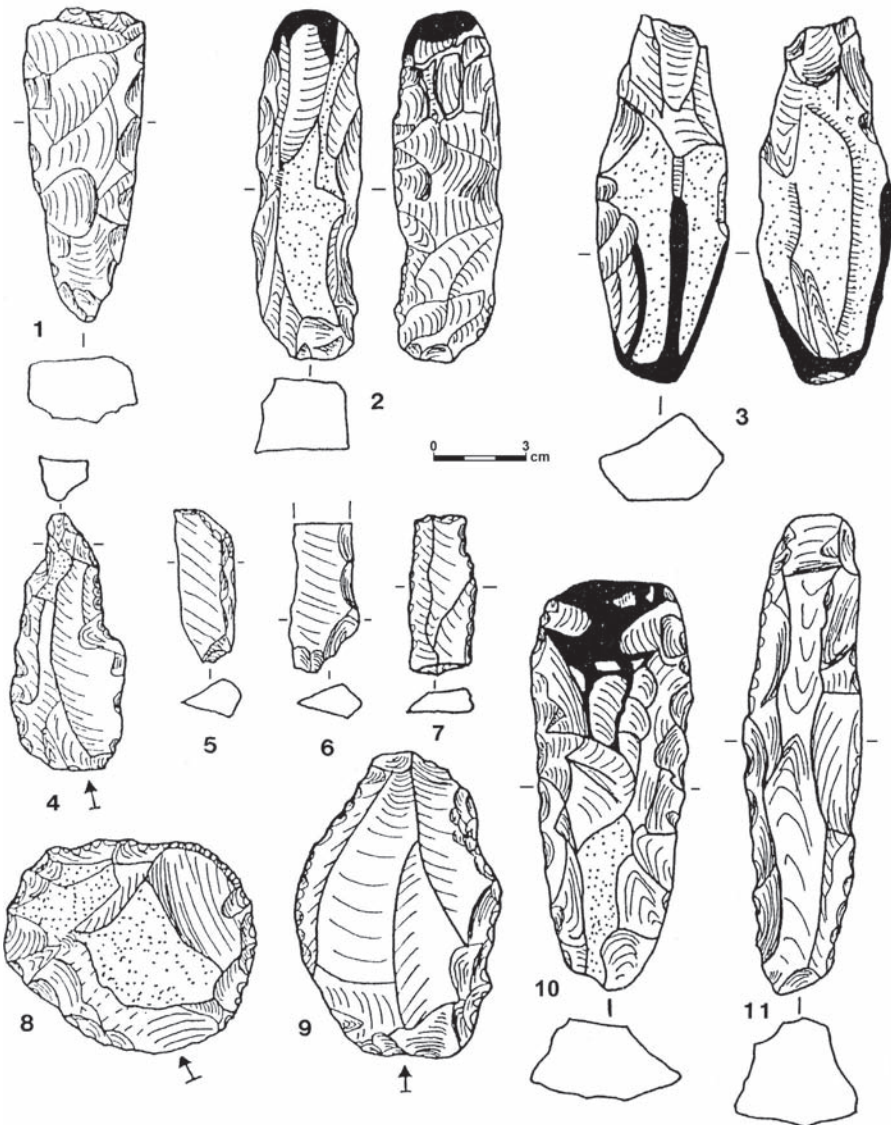
Discussion:

The flint assemblage bears characteristics of the Chalcolithic Period and the Wadi Rabah phase. Certain tool types are common to both periods but some are characteristic for one or the other. The polished adze, the thin backed and bi-truncated blade (sickle blade like), and the fan scraper could represent the Chalcolithic (Yeivin 1958, 40-44; Hennessey 1969, 17-18; Lee 1973, 249-260; Rosen 1982, 140; Crowfoot-Payne 1983, 716; Levi and Rosen 1987, 281-309). The Wadi Rabah phase is apparently represented by the chisel with the polished lateral edges (Kaplan 1969, fig.10; Gopher 1989a, figs. 43/44), the axe and the chisel with a rectangular cross-section (Kaplan 1977, 75) and probably also the thick, backed and bi-truncated blade (similar to a sickle blade type D – Kaplan 1969, 16 and fig. 13/8; Gopher 1989a, 95; Gopher and Orrelle 1990, 70). It should be emphasized that even though the indications seem convincing, they should not be considered as abso-

lute because of the rather small assemblage and the resemblance of tools from both periods.

The basalt artifacts, the conical bowls, and the base of the in-

cense burner are attributed to the Chalcolithic as well. To summarize, most flint artifacts and stone tools match the findings of the pottery shards which are attributed to the



557. el-Habayel (A): 1. Axe; 2. Polished chisel; 3. Chisel with bi-lateral polish; 4. Massive borer; 5-6. Blade similar to type D sickle; 7. Blade similar to type C sickle; 8. Fan scraper; 9. Backed knife; 10. Polished adze; 11. Chisel.

Chalcolithic. The discoid core with yellow patina seems intrusive and could be attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic.



Site no. 16

Mughur Abu Rishi

Isr. Grid Ref. 1842/1975

The flint assemblage:

Chalcolithic Period – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

Flake 4; Blade 2. Total – 6.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

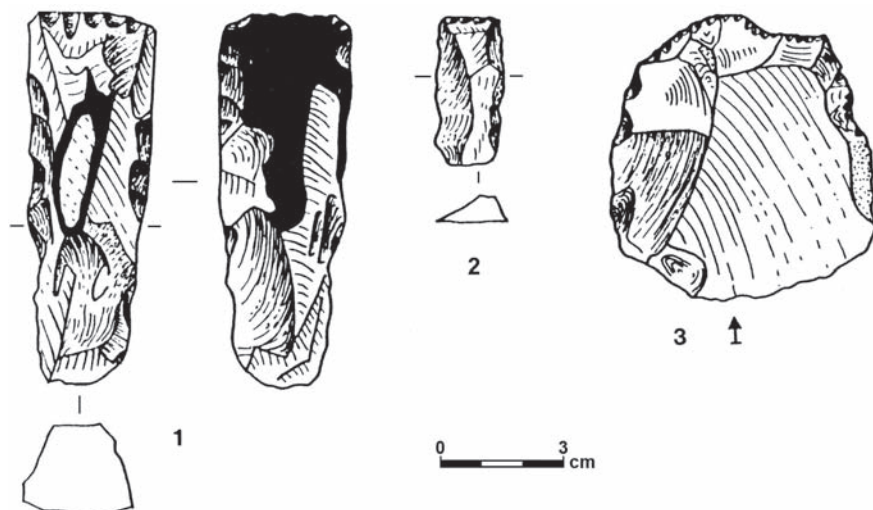
Backed and bi-truncated blade (similar to a sickle blade) 1; Polished axe 1; Axe (calcareous flint) 1; Chisel 1; Broken bifacial artifacts 4; End scraper on flake 1; Side-scraper

on primary flake 1; Notch on flake 1; Awl on flake 1. Total – 12.

Total of flint artifacts – 16.

Discussion:

The blade (similar to a sickle blade), the polished axe with a trapezoid cross-section, the side-scraper and the tool assemblage generally are in accordance with Chalcolithic tool-kits (Yeivin 1958; Lee 1973; Roshwalb 1981; Levi and Rosen 1987). The pottery findings of the site were



558. Mughur Abu Rishi: 1. Polished axe; 2. Backed and bi-truncated blade (similar to a sickle blade); 3. End scraper on flake.

attributed to the Chalcolithic as well. No artifacts pointing to a different period were found.



Site no. 29

el-Mabhashiyye

Isr. Grid Ref. 1847/2005

The flint and stone assemblages:

Chalcolithic Period – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

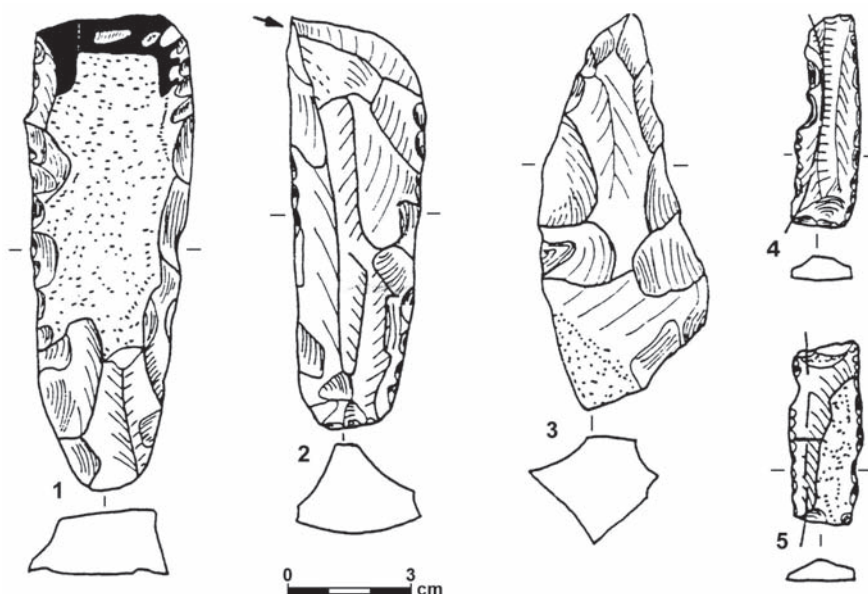
Core 1; Ridge blade 2; Flake 2; Blade 1; Limestone pestle 1. Total – 7.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

Backed and bi-truncated sickle

blade 4; Polished axe 2; Adze 4; Chisel 1; Pick 1; Massive limestone adze (hoe?) 1; Broken bifacial artifacts 7; Bifacial tool with an oblique burin blow; End scraper 2; Notch 6; Denticulate 1; Awl 2; Borer 1; Retouched flake 1; Truncation 2. Total – 36.

Total of flint and stone artifacts – 43.



559. el-Mabhashiyye: 1. Polished axe; 2. Bifacial tool with an oblique burin blow; 3. Pick; 4-5. Backed and bi-truncated sickle blade.

Discussion:

The backed and truncated sickle blades (type C, Gopher 1989a, 95), the axes, the adzes and the chisel, all of them with a trapezoid cross-section, are characteristic of the Chal-

colithic Period (Yeivin 1958; Hennessey 1969; Lee 1973; Levi and Rosen 1987). No artifacts pointing to a different period were found so the whole assemblage should be attributed to this period.



Site no. 31

‘Iraq el-Hamam (lower)

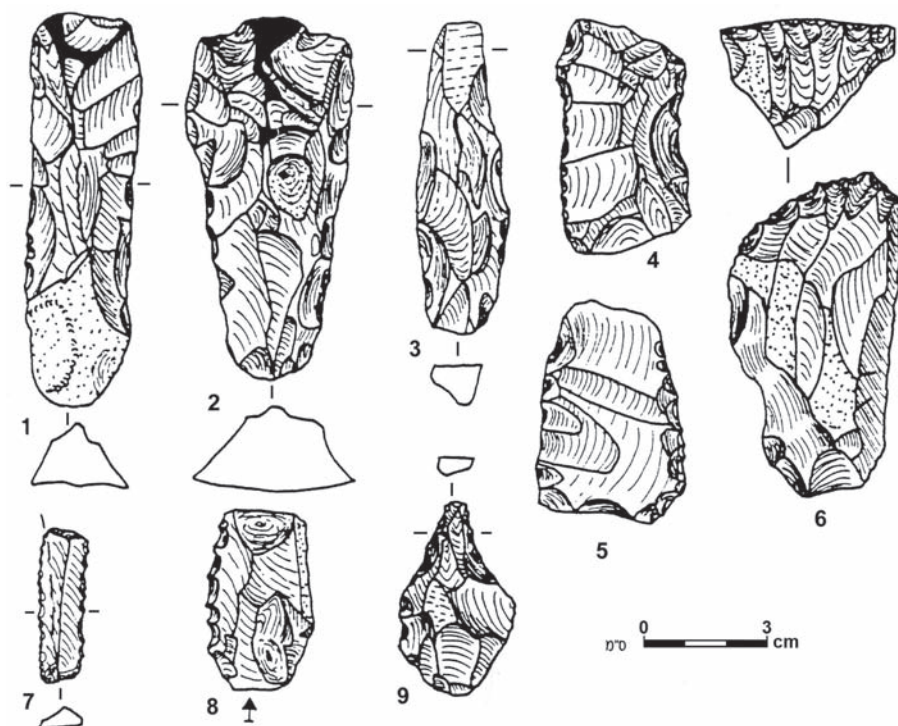
Isr. Grid Ref. 1897/2007

The flint assemblage:

Chalcolithic Period – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

Flake 3; Blade 1; Bladelet 1. Total



560. ‘Iraq el-Hamam (lower): 1-2. Polished adze; 3. Chisel; 4. Backed knife; 5. Side-scraper; 6. Carrinated end scraper; 7. Sickle blade; 8. Denticulate; 9. Borer.

– 5.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

Backed and bi-truncated sickle blade 1; Adze 4; Chisel 3; Pick 1; Broken or unfinished bifacial artifact 5; Side-scraper on CTE (core trimming element) 1; Notch 2; Denticulate 2; Awl on retouched blade 1; Borer 1; Truncation 1; Backed knife 1. Total – 25.

Total of flint artifacts – 30.

Discussion:

The assemblage is attributed to the

Chalcolithic (Yeivin 1958; Hennessey 1969; Lee 1973; Levi and Rosen 1987). The adzes, chisels and sickle blade and their morphology are typical of the period. The awl was prepared from a fragment with lateral abrupt retouch on both sides and both faces were partly polished, it apparently served earlier as a chisel. The side scraper was prepared from a CTE detached at a right angle to previous detachments. Both the flint and pottery assemblages are attributed to the period.



Site no. 32

Mrah es-Sbeh

Isr. Grid Ref. 1905/2008

The flint assemblage: Chalcolithic Period – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

Flake core 2; Primary flake 2; Flake 2; Blade 2. Total – 8.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

Backed and bi-truncated sickle blade 2; Backed and bi-truncated blade (similar to a sickle blade) 1; Dihedral burin 1; Axe (polished on both faces) 1; Adze 2; Chisel 1; Chisel (fragment) 1; Pick 1; Notch 2; Naturally backed knife 1; Backed knife 1; Retouched flake 3; Retouched blade 1; Hammerstone (on previous bifacial artifact) 1; Varia 1.

Total – 20.

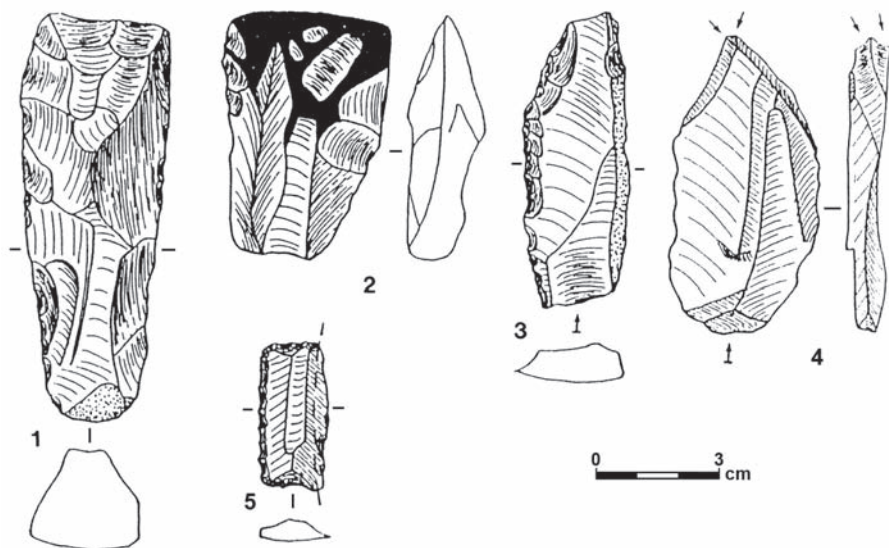
Total of flint artifacts – 28.

Discussion:

Similarly to most other sites in the area, the artifacts were prepared from light coloured, mostly calcareous flint. The composition and technology match these from the Chalcolithic. Typical tools of this period are the backed and bi-truncated sickle blade and the adze with trapezoid cross-section (Yeivin 1958; Hennessey 1969; Lee 1973; Levi and Rosen 1987). An exception is the dihedral burin which is typical to earlier periods and rare in the Chalcolithic. It was prepared from the same flint mentioned

above and therefore should not be considered as intrusive. Burins are present in the previous Wadi Rabah

phase (Gopher 1989a; Gopher and Orrelle 1990) but there are not enough indications for continuity.



561. Mrah es-Sbeh: 1. Adze; 2. Polished axe; 3. Naturally backed knife; 4. Dihedral burin; 5. Sickle blade.



Site no. 37

Mrah Ra'yan

Isr. Grid Ref. 1856/1986

The flint assemblage:

Not defined.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

Primary flake 7; Flake 7; Blade 1; Chunk 2; Total – 17.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

Nosed end scraper 1; End scraper on primary flake 1; Serrated side-

scraper on flake 1; Side-scraper on chunk 1; Notch on primary flake 2; Denticulate on primary flake 1; Borer on primary flake 1; Retouched primary flake 2; Retouched blade 3. Total – 13.

Total of flint artifacts – 30.

Discussion:

The assemblage does not contain any chronological markers which

could indicate the period. Most of the unretouched pieces were primary elements and half of the tools were also prepared from primary elements. No cores were found at the site and it may be assumed that this was a workshop for the preparation

of cores. The fact that some of the artifacts were apparently prepared by the Levallois technique (but without preparation of the striking platform) and the side scrapers could point to the Middle Palaeolithic Period.



Site no. 41

Ras es-Salmeh

Isr. Grid Ref. 1864/1981

The flint assemblage:

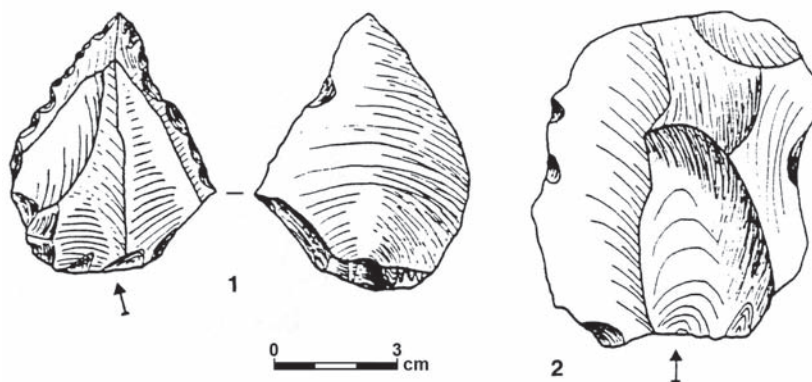
Middle Palaeolithic Period – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts and tools:

Levallois flake 1; Mousterian point 1. Total – 2.

Discussion:

Despite the fact that only two artifacts were found they may be attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic Period (Bordes 1961). Even if the findings were not *in situ* they point to human presence in the area during this period.



562. Ras es-Salmeh: 1. Mousterian point; 2. Levallois flake.

Site no. 46

Khallet et-Tawileh

Isr. Grid Ref. 1854/1939

The flint assemblage:

Chalcolithic Period – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

Levallois core 1; CTE 1; Ridge blade 1; Flake 3; Blade 3; Chip 1. Total – 10.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

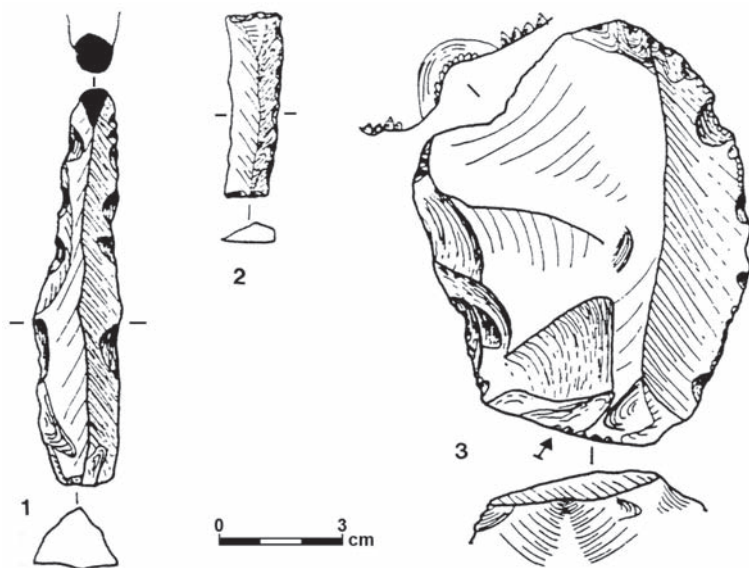
Backed and bi-truncated blade (similar to a sickle blade) 1; Polished chisel on ridge blade 1; Fragment of bifacial artifact 1; Side-scraper on flake 1; Notch 2; Denticulate

on flake 1; Retouched flake 3; Retouched blade 1; Truncation 1. Total – 12.

Total of flint artifacts – 22.

Discussion:

The small assemblage should be attributed to the Chalcolithic. The backed and bi-truncated blade, the polished chisel, the side scraper and the other artifacts as well correspond with assemblages from this period (Yeivin 1958; Hennessey 1969; Lee 1973; Levi and Rosen 1987) and the pottery findings from the site.



563. Khallet et-Tawileh: 1. Polished chisel; 2. Backed and bi-truncated blade; 3. Notched side-scraper.

Site no. 55

Khirbet ed-Der

Isr. Grid Ref. 1865/1906

The flint assemblage:

Not defined.

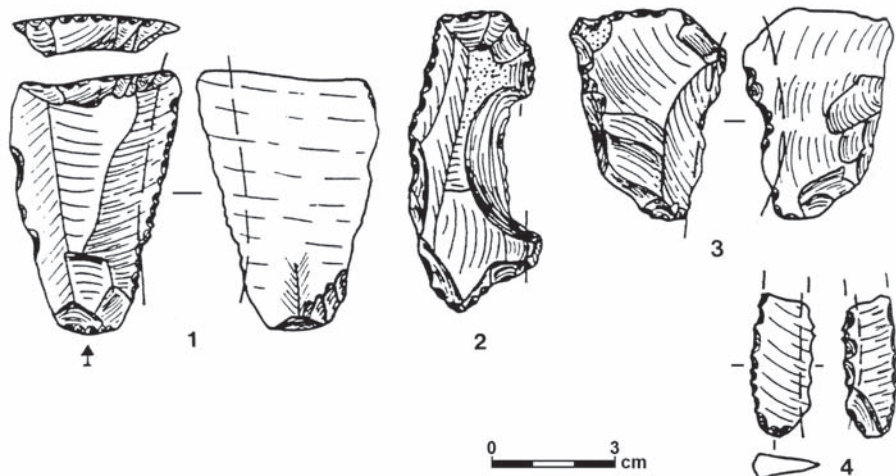
Tools and retouched artifacts:

Backed and truncated large geometric sickle segment 2; Backed and bi-truncated large geometric sickle segment with large notch (probably post depositional) 1; Backed and truncated sickle blade 1; Notch on truncated blade 1; Retouched flake 2. Total – 7.

Discussion:

Large geometric sickle segments were in use from Middle Bronze Age II until at least the end of Iron Age II. No morphological varieties were reported from assemblages of these periods and anyhow the sam-

ple size is rather small for comparisons. The single informative trait is the mean length of the artifacts (Rosen 1983, 198) – 61 mm in our case. This measure fits the values reported for the Late Bronze Age. A comparison to the assemblages of Tell Nagila (Middle Bronze Age II – Gilead 1973) and Gezer (Iron Age I – Rosen 1986) indicates similarity to both sites. The cross-check with the pottery assemblage complicates the picture still more. The assemblage contained shards from Middle Bronze Age II – 20%, Late Bronze Age – 30% and Iron Age I – 30%. The flint artifacts could be from any of these periods.



564. Khirbet ed-Der: 1-3. Large geometric sickle segment; 4. Backed and truncated sickle blade.

Site no. 66

Wadi el-Hammeh

Isr. Grid Ref. 1968/1975

The flint assemblage:

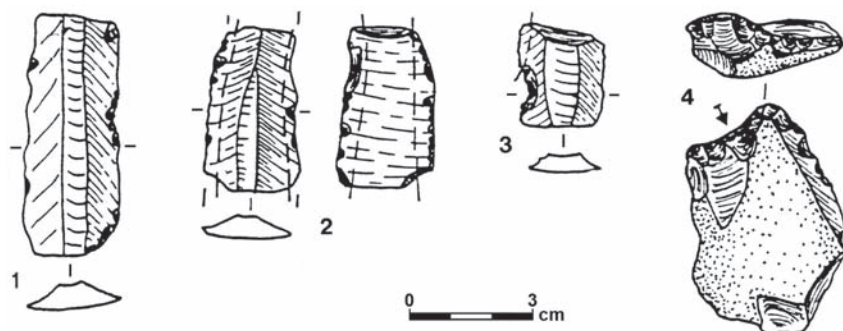
Middle Bronze Age I – highly reasonable identification (main part of the assemblage).

Tools and retouched artifacts:

Cananean sickle blade 1; Cananean blade 1; Backed and bi-truncated Cananean blade 1; Backed and truncated blade 1; Shouldered end scraper on primary flake 1; Notch on fragment of Cananean blade 1; Awl 1; Retouched flake 2. Total – 9.

Discussion:

Cananean blades are characteristic of Early Bronze and Middle Bronze I Ages (Rosen 1983, 127; 1989, 208). Most artifacts in the assemblage were produced by the Cananean technology. The backed and truncated blade, similar to Chalcolithic blades can apparently be found also in assemblages from the Middle Bronze Age I (see Rosen 1991, 11). Most of the pottery assemblage was attributed to Middle Bronze Age I and the flint assemblage should be attributed similarly.



565. Wadi el-Hammeh: 1. Cananean blade; 2. Cananean sickle blade; 3. Notch on fragment of Cananean blade; 4. Shouldered end scraper.

Site no. 82

Khirbet Umm Ghazal (Kh. esh-Shaqq)

Isr. Grid Ref. 1975/1945

The flint assemblage:

Early and Middle Bronze Age I, Iron Age – possible identification.

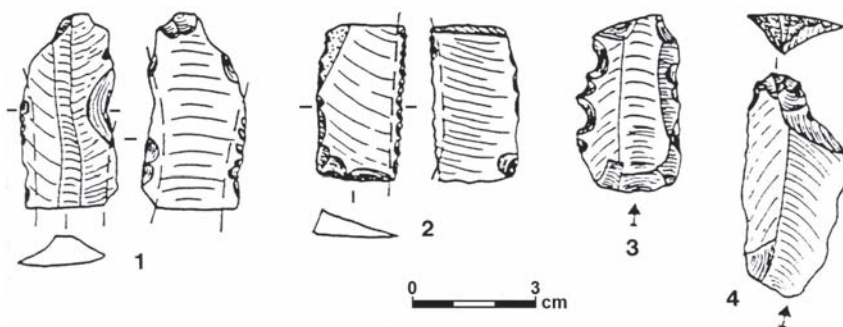
Tools and retouched artifacts:

Geometric sickle segment 1; Cananean sickle blade 1; Shouldered end scraper 1; Denticulate 1; Retouched blade with two ventral notches 1; Truncated flake 2; Retouched flake 1; Retouched blade 2. Total – 10.

Discussion:

Cananean sickle blades were in use during the Early Bronze Age

(Waechter 1958, 325; Schick 1978; Rosen 1985) and Middle Bronze Age I (Rosen 1989, 208). Most other flint artifacts could also belong to these periods. The pottery assemblage from the site was attributed to the Iron Age and the backed and truncated geometric sickle segment should be attributed similarly (Rosen 1983, 136; 1986, 262). The variety and the small number of artifacts do not allow further conclusions.



566. Khirbet Umm Ghazal: 1. Cananean sickle blade; 2. Geometric sickle segment; 3. Denticulate; 4. Shouldered end scraper.

Site no. 83

Muntar esh-Shaqq

Isr. Grid Ref. 1978/1944

The flint assemblage: Pre-Pottery Neolithic Period – reasonable identification.

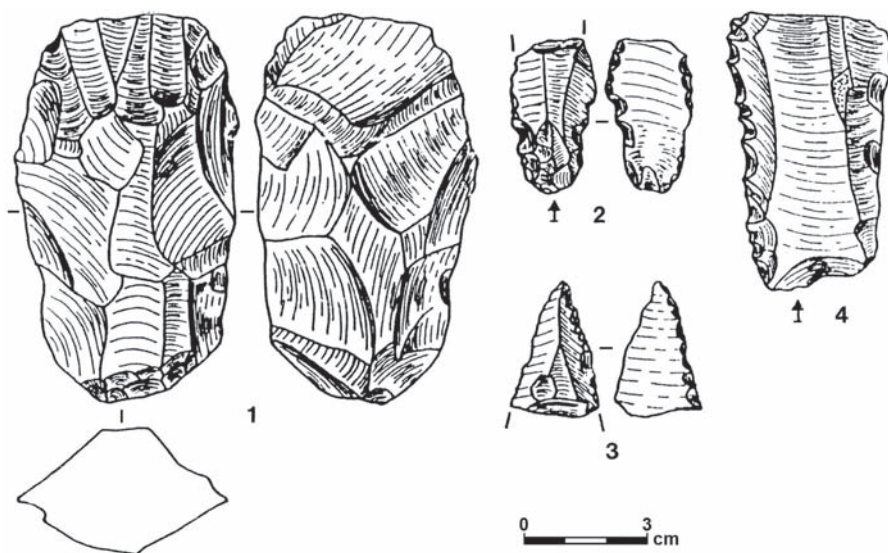
Artifacts without retouch and waste: Flake 2; Blade 2. Total – 4.

Tools and retouched artifacts: Byblos arrowhead (broken) 1; Retouched point (broken) 1; Axe with transversal blow 1; Denticulate 1; Awl 1. Total – 5.

Total of flint artifacts – 9.

Discussion: The composition of the assemblage and the limited quantity of artifacts make it difficult to define the period exactly.

The axe with a transversal blow is mainly attributed to the Pre Pottery Neolithic Period (Crowfoot-Payne 1983) but is present also in the Chalcolithic (Hennssey 1969, 17; Levi and Rosen 1987, 284). The broken Byblos arrowhead (Gopher 1985, 57) was mainly in use at a later stage of the Pre-Pottery Neolithic Period and the early Pottery Neolithic Period. No cross-check with the pottery assemblage, attributed completely to the Iron Age, was possible. It seems reasonable to attribute the flint assemblage to the Pre Pottery Neolithic Period.



567. Muntar esh-Shaqq: 1. Axe with transversal blow; 2. Byblos arrowhead (broken); 3. Retouched point (broken; arrowhead?); 4. Denticulate.

Site no. 90

Khirbet el-Meiyiteh

Isr. Grid Ref. 1942/1925

The flint assemblage:

Epi-Palaeolithic Period – the Natufian Culture (main part of the assemblage) – highly reasonable identification; Neolithic Period (few artifacts) – reasonable identification; Chalcolithic Period (few artifacts) – reasonable identification; Middle Bronze Age I (few artifacts) – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

Flake core 7; Flake-blade core 2; Bladelet core 10; CTE 4; Ridge blade 7; Primary flake 37; Flake 221; Blade 19; Fragment of blade 37; Bladelet 13; Fragment of bladelet 32; Burin spall 4; Chunk 153; Chip 141; Globular hammerstone 4; Hammerstone on core 1; Microburin 19. Total – 711.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

Sickle segments: Reaping knife (with tang) 1; Fragment with tang 1; Backed, truncated with fine retouch 1; Fragment with plain cutting edge 1; Cananean 3; Cananean fragment 2. Sickle segments total – 9.

Scrapers: End scraper on flake 10; Thumbnail scraper 4; End scraper on blade 6; *Déte* scraper 1; End scraper on truncation 7; End scraper with notch 3; Double end scrap-

er 2; Narrow carinated end scraper 1; Nucleiform (core) scraper 1; Transversal scraper 1. Scrapers total – 36.

Burins: Dihedral on flake 1; Dihedral *Déte* 1; Dihedral angled 1; Angled on natural pan 1; On truncation 1; Double on truncation 1; On concave truncation 2; Transversal 2; Flat faced 1. Burins total – 12.

Microlithes: Bladelet – retouched 2; Bladelet – partially retouched 5; Bladelet – retouched on ventral face 5; Bladelet – backed 3; Bladelet with oblique truncation 5; Arch backed 3; Micro-end scraper 1. Microlithes total – 24.

Geometric Microlithes: Lunate 2; Triangle 1. Geometric microlithes total – 3.

Raclette with burin blow 1; Burin-scraper 4; Notch on flake 44; Double notch 3; Denticulate 1; Borer 8; Awl 8; Backed knife 1; Retouched flake 20; Retouched blade 5; Backed blade 4; Truncation on flake 3; Varia 6.

Total of tools and retouched artifacts – 192.

Total of flint artifacts – 903.

Discussion:

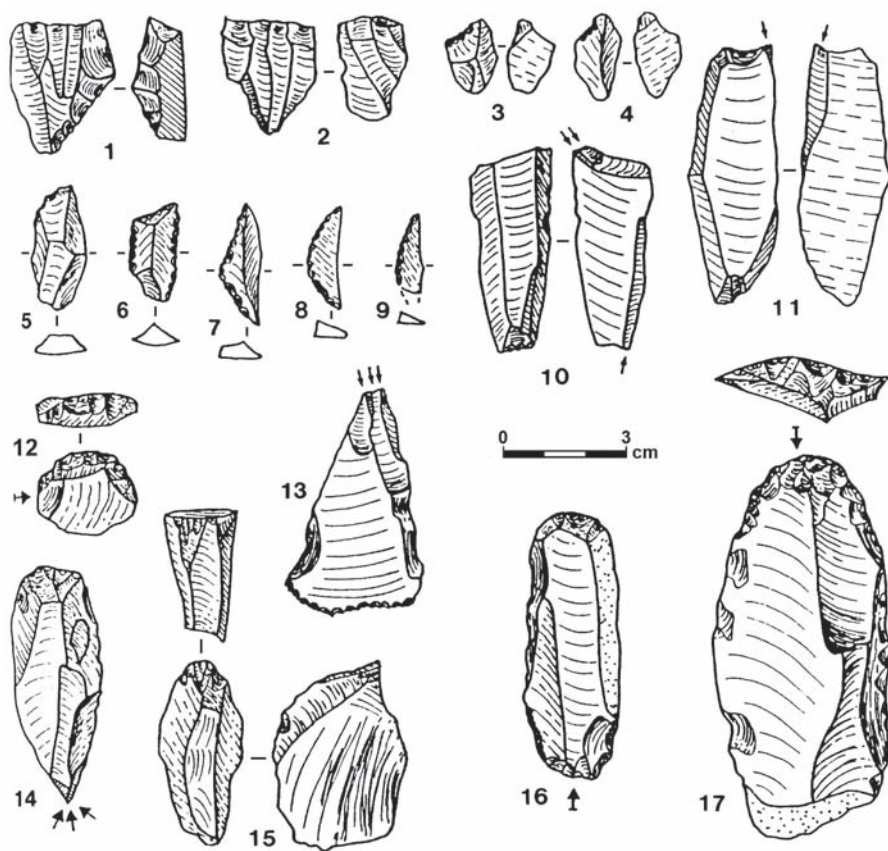
Most of the tools, cores and the waste materials are from gray and

brown coloured dark flint. The dimensions of these dark artifacts are in most cases small and the cores are exhausted. A similar phenomenon was observed at other Epi-Palaeolithic sites in the area such as Khirbet Malih (C). The larger artifacts were prepared mostly from light-coloured flint and apparently belong to the later phases of the site. An investigation of the sources of raw flint is beyond the scope of

this study.

The division of the artifacts in the assemblage points to human presence at the site during four pre- and proto-historic periods:

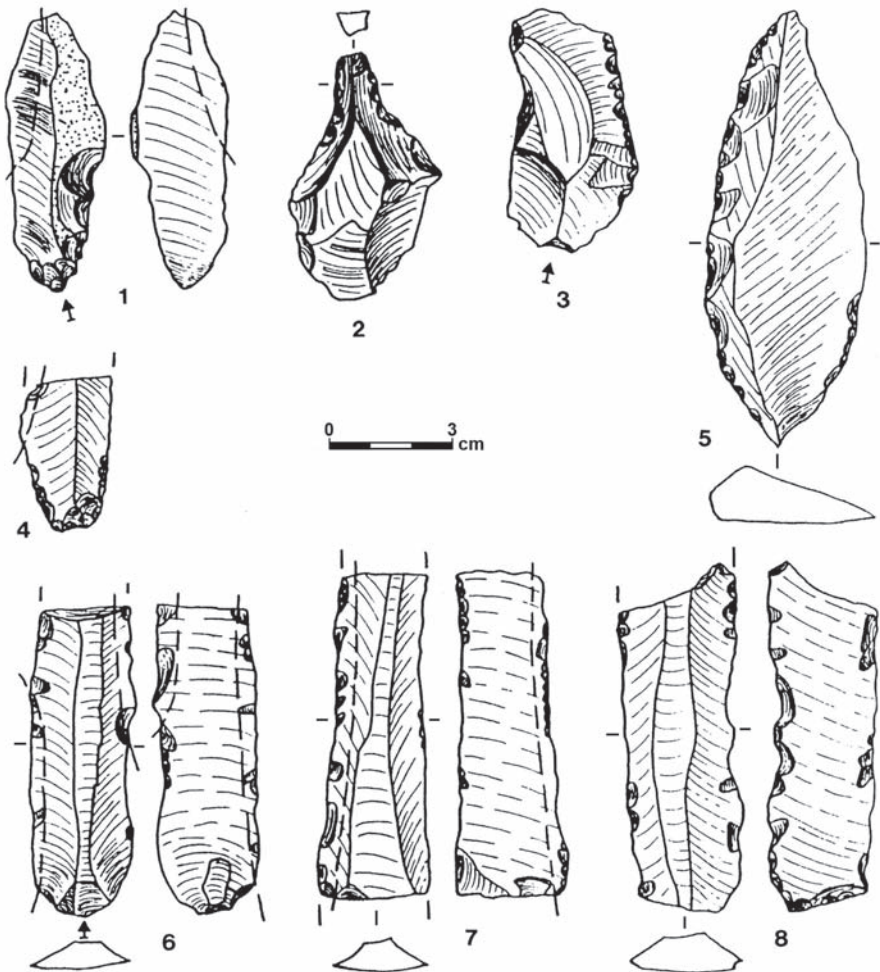
The earliest, represented by the majority of the artifacts, is the Epi-Palaeolithic Period. The relatively small number of microlithes in the assemblage was caused by the difficulty in locating such small



568. Khirbet el-Meiyyeh: 1-2. Bladelet core; 3-4. Microburin; 5. Arch-backed microlithe; 6. Obliquely truncated microlithe; 7. Triangle; 8-9. Backed lunate; 10. Double burin; 11. Angled burin; 12. Thumbnail scraper; 13. Raclette-Burin; 14. Burin-scraper; 15. Narrow, carinated scraper; 16. Double end scraper; 17. End scraper.

artifacts in a surface survey. Nevertheless, the bladelet cores, small waste materials, microburins, end scrapers, narrow carinated scrapers, burins and microlithes including lunates and a triangle point clearly to the Natufian phase of the period. The abrupt backed, narrow lunates and the triangle indicate perhaps

the Late Natufian (Bar-Yosef and Valla 1979), similarly to Einan Ic (Valla 1984), Har Horsha (Marks and Larson 1977) and Rosh Zin (Henry 1976). The large assemblage, including all the components – exhausted cores, primary flakes, industrial waste and a large variety of shaped tools – point to rather in-



569. Khirbet el-Meiyyiteh: 1. Reaping knife with tang; 2. Borer; 3, 5. Backed knife; 4. Fragment of reaping knife with tang; 6-7. Cananean sickle blade. 8. Cananean blade.

tensive activities at the site, either as a repeatedly visited campsite or as a base camp. The location of the site, on a terrace above a still flowing spring, similar to many other sites of this period, supports this assumption.

The Pre Pottery Neolithic B Period is apparently represented by tanged reaping knives. These tools may be considered as *type fossils* (Crowfoot-Payne 1983; Gopher 1989a). The artifacts were prepared from light coloured flint, and possibly some of the scrapers and burins prepared from the same flint also belong to this period. The relatively small number of indicative artifacts point to a low level of activities during this period.

The Chalcolithic Period is repre-

sented by the backed and truncated sickle blades and the coarse borers (Lee 1973; Levy and Rosen 1987). The backed knife reappears during the Pottery Neolithic Period (Gopher 1989a) but here it apparently belongs to the Chalcolithic. This assumption is supported by the fact that no other flint or pottery artifacts which could be attributed to the Pottery Neolithic Period were found. The scarcity of Chalcolithic artifacts points to a low level of activity during this period.

Cananean blades are *type fossils* indicating either the Early Bronze Age or Middle Bronze Age I. The pottery assemblage of the site was attributed to the latter and the Cananean sickle blades should be attributed similarly.



Site no. 94

Khirbet Malih (C)

Isr. Grid Ref. 1957/1930

The flint assemblage:

Epi-Palaeolithic Period – the Geometric Kebaran Culture (main part of the assemblage) – highly reasonable identification.

Artifacts without retouch and waste:

Flake core 3; Bladelet core 10; CTE 3; Primary flake 17; Ridge blade 2; Flake 131; Blade 5; Blade fragment 23; Bladelet 26; Bladelet fragment

95; Burin spall 7; Chunk 47; Chip 129. Total – 498.

Tools and retouched artifacts:

Scrapers: Core scraper 4; Thumbnail scraper 2; End scraper on blade 3; Double end scraper on blade 1; End scraper on retouched blade 2; End scraper on truncation 2; Nosed end scraper, wide 4; Nosed end scraper, narrow 1; End scraper on notched piece 1; Side scraper 1.

Scrapers total – 22.

Burins: Dihedral 2; Angled dihedral 1; On natural pan 7; Dihedral double 1; On concave truncation 1; On concave truncation, double 1; Flat faced 3. Burins total – 16.

Microlithes: Falita point 1; Bladelet – partially retouched 2; Bladelet – retouched (fragment) 1; Bladelet – ventrally retouched 1; Bladelet – backed (fragment) 3; Bladelet – backed with notch (fragment) 1; Bladelet – narrow, obliquely truncated 3; Bladelet – broad, obliquely truncated 4; Bladelet – narrow, arch backed (fragment) 1; Bladelet – broad, arch backed 3; Bladelet with bilateral abrupt retouch (fragment) 1. Microlithes total – 21.

Geometric Microlithes: Proto rectangle 1; Rectangle 4; Rectangle/Trapeze (fragment) 5; Asymmetric trapeze 1; Trapeze 3. Geometric microlithes total – 14.

Notch 16; Truncation 10; Plane on flake 1; Burin-scraper 2; Retouched blade 12; Retouched blade (fragment) 4; Twisted arch backed blade 3; Obliquely truncated blade 2; Cananean blade (fragment) 2; Fan scraper (fragment) 2; Borer 3; Varia 5.

Total of tools and retouched artifacts – 135.

Total of flint artifacts – 633.

Remark:

A small part of the assemblage seems intrusive. The Cananean blades and

the fan scrapers apparently originate from the Bronze Age.

Discussion:

The site is located on the northern bank, about 15 m above and 150 m from the river bed of Wadi el-Malih on a small hillock, in the close vicinity of a fresh water spring which still serves the local population. The border of the site to the north is a small ravine and a road. At this section the river is perennial most years, but its water, originating from springs to the west, is too saline today for human purposes. On top of the hillock a few un-hewn stones protruded from the ground indicating a stone structure. The total absence of pottery and the scarcity of late flint tools do not allow conclusions about the character of this architecture without excavation. Most artifacts were found on top of the hillock (15 m X 20 m). On the slopes there were fewer and fewer pieces and on foot of the hillock no flint artifacts were found, probably as the result of erosion. A similar phenomenon was observed at the Natufian site of Khirbet el-Meiyiteh, about 1 km upstream to the west.

The relatively large number of bladelet cores, the presence of many bladelets and bladelet fragments, up to 40% of the unretouched artifacts, pointed to a microlithic industry of the Epi-Palaeolithic Period. In order to define to which stage of the Epi-Palaeolithic the site should be

attributed a short comparison to contemporaneous sites was carried out and a close similarity to Geometric Kebaran assemblages, mainly from the coastal plain was observed (Bar-Yosef 1970, 179); the data are given in Table 1. The comparison was carried out in accordance with the type list of Bar-Yosef (1970); intrusive artifacts were excluded.

The comparison to Neveh David, Negev and Sinai sites shows a similarity of tool types but not of their relative share in the assemblages. The phenomenon could be caused by the difference in collecting techniques or by environmental reasons. In regularly excavated sites, the excavated earth is sieved or wet sieved and the share of recovered microlithes in the assemblage increases remarkably (Table 2). Typical Kebaran artifacts, such as elongated, backed, obliquely truncated bladelets and arch-backed elongated bladelets are nearly completely absent. Similarly, lunates and microburins typical to the later Natufian were not found. Rectangles and trapezes were the most numerous pieces among the microlithes and these are typical to the Geometric Kebaran.

The character of the assemblage indicates that the source of raw flint was quite distant. Exhausted cores, the rarity of primary flakes and CTE, indicate that the initial stage of core preparation was executed elsewhere while the abundance of

flakes, chunks and chips proves that the final stages of tool preparation was carried out at the site. The location of the site on a hillock high above the bank of the riverbed and the ravine to the north proves that the assemblage was *in situ*. The setting on a terrace above a riverbed is similar to other sites of the period: Neveh David, Nahal Zin sites, and other sites in Wadi el-Malih and Wadi Far'ah in this survey.

The area of the site (about 300 sq. m) is close to the area of other open air sites of the period – up to 200 sq. m. (Bar-Yosef 1970) and as reported in later publications about temporary sites – up to 400 sq. m (Bar-Yosef 1981; Kaufman 1992, 178). This is in accordance with the division of the sites of this period to small, temporary camp sites as opposed to large base sites covering an area of 1000-1500 sq. m (Ronen et al. 1975; Kaufman 1986, 1989).

Conclusions:

The site of Khirbet Malih (C) should be attributed to the Geometric Kebaran phase of the Epi-Palaeolithic Period and the assemblage seems to be *in situ*. The composition of the assemblage is in accordance with the composition of other surface collections, as opposed to assemblages from excavated and sieved sites with different percentages of artifacts. The size and location of the site point to a seasonal or temporary camp site. Only an excavation could define the depth of the

flint-bearing horizon and the character of the stone structures.

	Khirbet Malih (C)		Geometric Kebaran A
The artifacts	N	%	%
Scrapers	12	9.8	9.6 – 26.2
Carinated and Nucleiform (core) scrapers	9	7.3	3.3 – 8.4
Burins	16	13.0	2.9 -5.6 (23.5)
Non geometric microlithes	21	17.0	18.7 – 46.3
Geometric microlithes	14	11.4	4.5 – 15.9
Notches	16	13.0	3 – 17
Borers	0	0	0

Table 1: Comparison of percentages of main tool categories from Khirbet Malih (C) to the range of percentages in other sites of the Geometric Kebaran A phase (Bar-Yosef 1970, 179).

	Khirbet Malih (C)		Neveh David	Ma'aleh Zik	Nahal Zin - D5
The artifacts	N	%	%	%	%
Scrapers	21	17.0	8.35	3.1	10.6
Burins	16	13.0	5.88	0.1	1.5
Truncations	10	8.1	1.55	9.0	8.5
Microlithes	21	17.0	18.26	34.7	20.5
Geometric microlithes	14	11.4	55.72	47.6	38.2
Notches	16	13.0	4.02	3.2	13.7

Table 2: Comparison of percentages of main tool categories from Khirbet Malih (C) to three excavated sites: Neveh David – Kaufman, 1987; Ma'aleh Zik – Goring Morris, 1978; Nahal Zin - D5 – Marks, 1976.